

Question 29 · Unit 2 · 8 Marks

An organisation has an appraisal system but employees report that it does not help their development. Apply HRD principles to improve the appraisal process.

Introduction

Application: diagnose why appraisal is not developmental, then redesign using HRD principles (purpose, feedback, counselling, IDP, climate, integration, evaluation).

Detailed points

- 1. Clarify purpose in policy and talk.** State that the primary purpose is development; rewards use data but the discussion is about growth. Mixed messages ('this is for increment only') kill development.
- 2. Start with role clarity and joint goals.** If employees never agreed KRAs, review feels unfair. Principle of participation.
- 3. Train managers in evidence-based feedback.** Replace labels with incidents and impact. Principle: line managers as developers need skill.
- 4. Mandatory counselling conversation.** Protect time; ban corridor signatures. Two-way talk is the HRD heart.
- 5. End with IDP and follow-up.** Every review produces 2–3 development actions with dates, reviewed quarterly. Principle of continuity.
- 6. Link to training and career.** Gaps go to TNA; aspirations go to career talk. Principle of integration.
- 7. Climate safeguards.** Self-appraisal, no public humiliation, process appeal. Fairness principle. Fearless data is better data.
- 8. Evaluate the appraisal process itself.** Survey 'did this help my development?' Hold managers accountable for quality of conversations, not only timely forms. Principle of evaluation.

Conclusion. Show a redesign, not a new form colour. Purpose, skilled dialogue, IDP, links, climate, and evaluation convert ritual appraisal into an HRD subsystem.